

Custom Islands: the guide

A picture-by-picture guide to **Custom Islands** (DynamicIslands), a [Raft](#) mod for the [Raft Mod Loader](#). It is for players who want new islands in their worlds, and for builders who want to make islands of their own. The [README](#) has the full reference (every setting, file and command); this guide shows you around.

The guide follows the heart of the mod first: **meeting custom islands** while you sail (sections 2-3), **building your own** in the editor (4-5), and giving them **stories**: quests, doors and keys, story items, and islands that bring other islands (6-7). Section 8 is about playing together. The **optional systems** that change a whole world - world rules, the world randomizer, the extra options, the island list and the level up system - are gathered in section 9, followed by the files, the console commands and help.



A custom island met while sailing: made by the mod's island generator, with Raft's own palms, rocks and reef.

Contents

1. Installing
2. Starting a new world
3. Sailing: custom islands in your world
4. Building your own island: the editor
5. Making islands come alive
6. Stories: quests, behaviours, story items
7. World plans: which islands a world gets
8. Playing together
9. World settings: rules and extra systems
 - 9.1 The World settings window

- 9.2 World rules: monster difficulty and build cost
- 9.3 The world randomizer
- 9.4 Extra options
- 9.5 Islands while sailing
- 9.6 The level up system

10. Settings files

11. Console commands

12. Questions and problems

1. Installing

Experimental Alpha Release: this is the mod's first release, an early alpha. Things are likely to change, some systems might be unstable, and progress is not guaranteed to be saved - back up the worlds you care about (Raft keeps them in `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User`). The main menu shows this in the **EXPERIMENTAL ALPHA RELEASE** box at the top right, with the mod's version. **Got it** folds it into a slim bar (its **Show** opens it again); the mod remembers that for this version only (in `notice.txt`), so a new version shows the whole box again.

1. Install the **Raft Mod Loader** (RML) from raftmodding.com and start Raft through it.
2. Put `DynamicIslands.rmod` into Raft's `mods` folder (for example `...\steamapps\common\Raft\mods\`), or install the mod from its raftmodding.com page.
3. Start Raft with RML's **Play** button. The first start takes a little longer: RML compiles the mod.

The mod keeps its files in `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\`: your islands (`*.island`), the settings files (`spawnpool.txt` and others, see [section 10](#)) and the world plans (`plans\`).

Playing together? Every player needs the mod. The host's islands, files and settings are sent to everyone who joins (see [section 8](#)).

2. Starting a new world

Click **NEW WORLD** in Raft's main menu. Raft's box looks as it always does, with two things of the mod at the bottom right: the **Custom Islands plan** and the **WORLD SETTINGS...** button, which says how many settings differ from plain Raft.



Raft's New Game box with the Custom Islands plan (Random islands) and the World settings button.

Part	What it does
Custom Islands plan	Which custom islands the world gets: Random islands (they appear by chance while you sail), No custom islands , or a plan such as Adventure (a story from island to island; see section 7)
World settings...	Opens the World settings window: the world's rules, the world randomizer, the extra options and which islands turn up while sailing (section 9). The button reads <code>Raft's own</code> while nothing differs from plain Raft, otherwise how many settings you changed (<code>3 changed</code>)

Then click Raft's **Create** as usual. Your choices are remembered for the next new world. They belong to the world: saved with it, the same for every player, and every new world gets its own.

Just want new islands? Leave the plan on **Random islands**, leave World settings as they are (`Raft's own`) and create the world: islands turn up while you sail ([section 3](#)), and the rest of Raft plays as it always does. The World settings are optional extras for players who know Raft well; they are described together near the end of this guide.



The whole main menu. The EDITOR button opens the island editor (section 4).

3. Sailing: custom islands in your world

Islands appear while you sail

With the **Random islands** plan, now and then an island appears **250-350 m ahead of the raft** (about one island every 4 km). It can be:

- one of **your own islands** (every saved island takes part unless `spawnpool.txt` says otherwise),
- a **brand-new generated island**: a random size and style (tropical, snowy, desert, forest or volcanic), sometimes flying; it is saved as `gen-<style>-<seed>.island`, so it stays in that world,
- a **map type**: a sandbar, a wreck of raft blocks, an atoll or a sunken island (more in 4.6).

Which of these a world may meet can be chosen when it is created (9.5). The optional world settings add more things to meet at sea: the randomizer's odd islands, large islands and boss lairs (9.3) and ghost rafts (9.4).

Islands keep clear of Raft's own islands and of each other, and Raft won't put its islands on top of them later. Islands far behind the raft are unloaded (after 800 m) and come back when you return.

On the Receiver: once you have built Raft's Receiver, custom islands show as **green dots** with their distance, even far ones. An island a rule brought (a quest reward, a plan) carries its name on its dot.

Arriving

An island with a name shows it as a **banner** when you come near (once per island per session), with its author and a short welcome if the builder wrote them.



Arriving at "Van Island", one of the world randomizer's oddity islands.

What you can do on an island

Custom islands work like Raft's own: you can **walk** on them, the **raft runs aground** on them, and you can **chop** palms, pines, birches and mango trees and **pick up** rocks, ores, clay, sand, berries, pineapples, flowers and more. What you took **stays taken** (also after saving, loading and sailing away), and it **grows back** after 3 in-game days (the island's builder or `spawnpool1.txt` can change that).



On a generated tropical island: Raft's bamboo, palms and plants, placed where Raft's own islands have them.



A generated island with the Nature setting on "Jungle": you have to squeeze between the trees.

Diving: generated islands rise from a deep sea floor like Raft's own: a sandy shelf about 10 m deep with corals and sea plants, then a drop-off. Giant clams, silver algae, stones, ores, scrap and the seaweed on sea vines can be picked up.



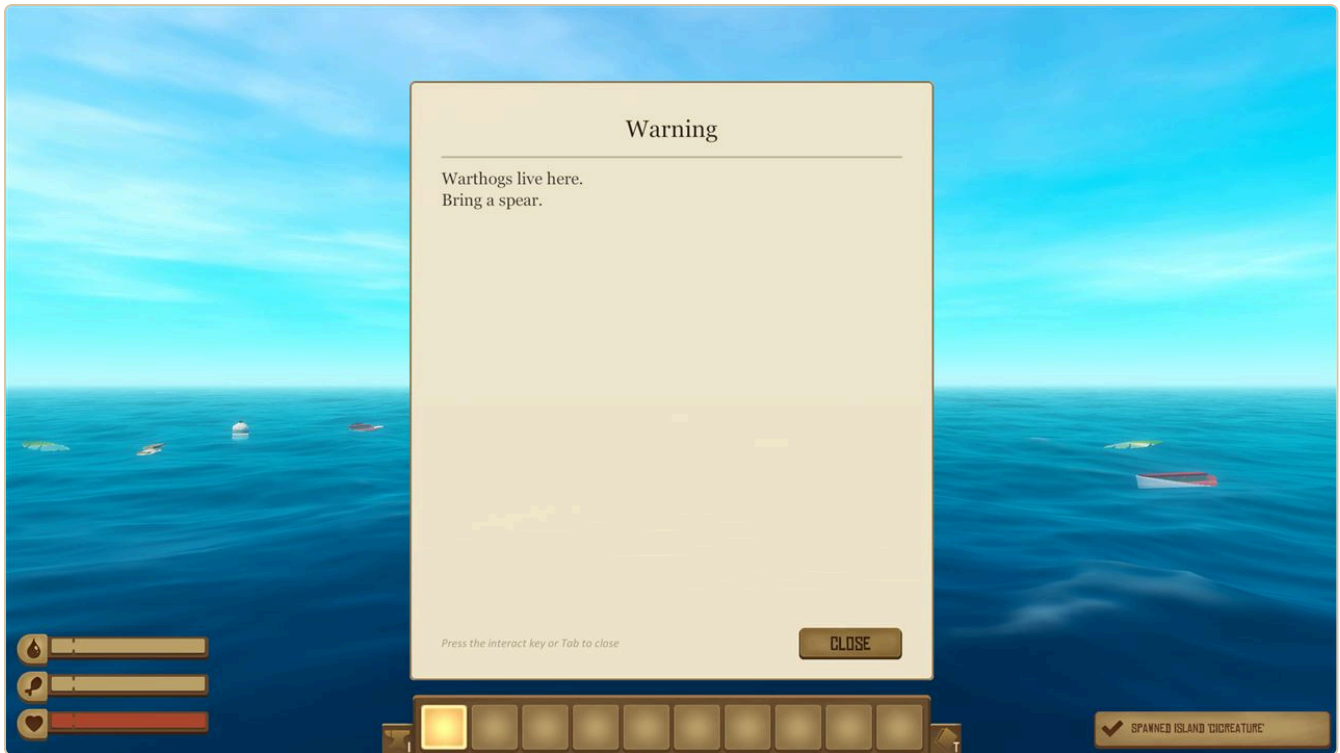
Under water around a generated island: the shelf, the reef, the drop-off and the slope further down.

Flying and sunken islands: some islands float high in the sky (build stairs or pillars up from the raft), others lie under the surface for divers.

Notes, chests, zones and creatures

The builder of an island can give it much more than land (see [section 5](#)). In a world:

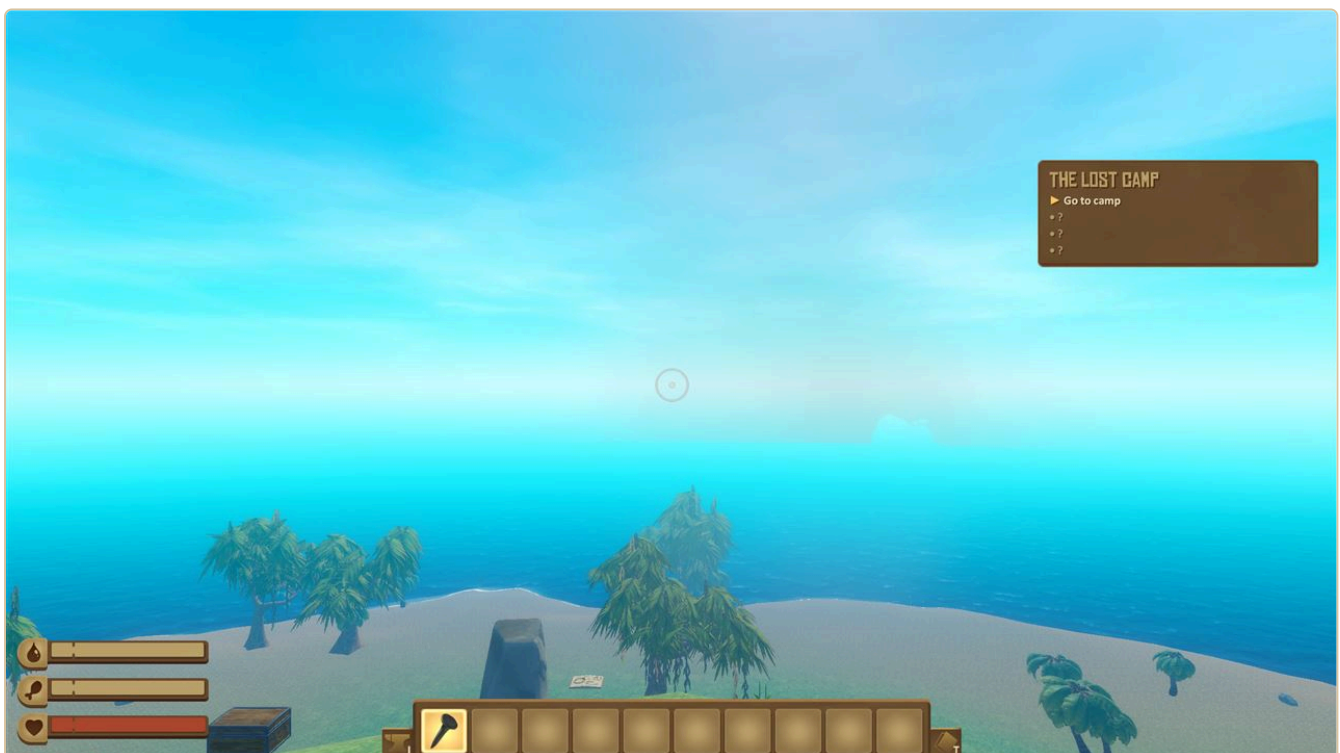
- **Notes:** look at a readable object (a sign, a paper, a bottle...) and press the interact key (**E**) to read it. Close it with E, Tab, Esc or the button.
- **Chests:** look at one and press **E**: the items go into your inventory. The chest is then empty for everyone until it fills up again (after the regrow days, or never). Some chests are **locked** until you have their key.
- **Trigger zones:** invisible areas that fire when a player walks in: a message, items, or an **ambush** (animals that appear the moment you step in).
- **Creatures:** Raft's own animals at the island's creature spots, with the builder's toughness, size and colour. Warthogs and bears fight you; chickens, goats and llamas can be caught with Raft's net launcher and kept on the raft. Killed and caught animals come back after the regrow days unless the builder said never.



A note found on an island ("Warthogs live here. Bring a spear."). Press E, Tab or Esc to close it.

Quests

An island with a quest shows a **quest panel** on the right when you arrive, with its steps: go somewhere, read a note, open a chest, defeat or catch animals, collect story items, find journal pages. Each step done shows what's next; the last one gives the reward to every player near the island.



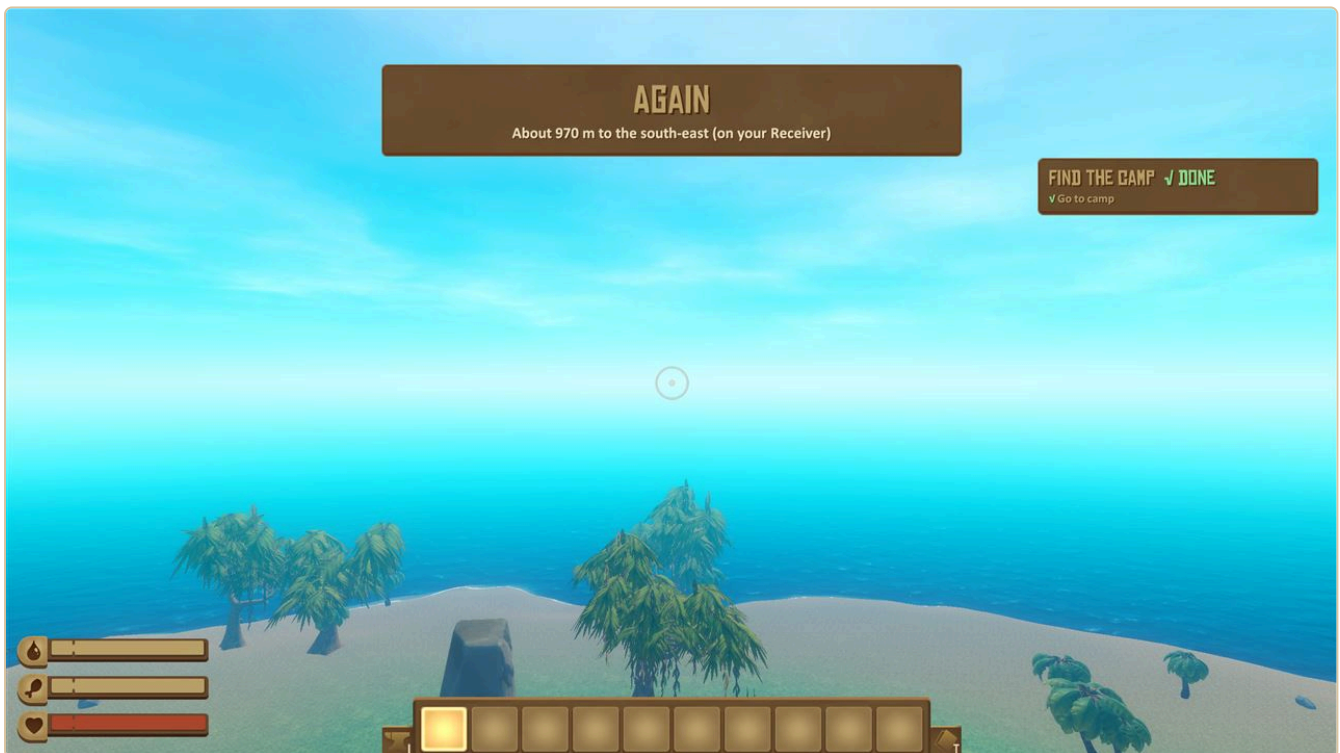
The quest panel of "The lost camp" on the right: the first step is "Go to camp".



Quest complete: the banner, every step ticked in the panel, and the reward (planks and rope) in the inventory.

New islands from quests and rules

A finished quest (or a plan's rule) can **bring a new island**: every player sees a banner with a message and how far and which way it is, and the island's dot on the Receiver carries its name.



A rule brought a new island: "About 970 m to the south-east (on your Receiver)". The quest panel shows the finished step.

The journal (J)

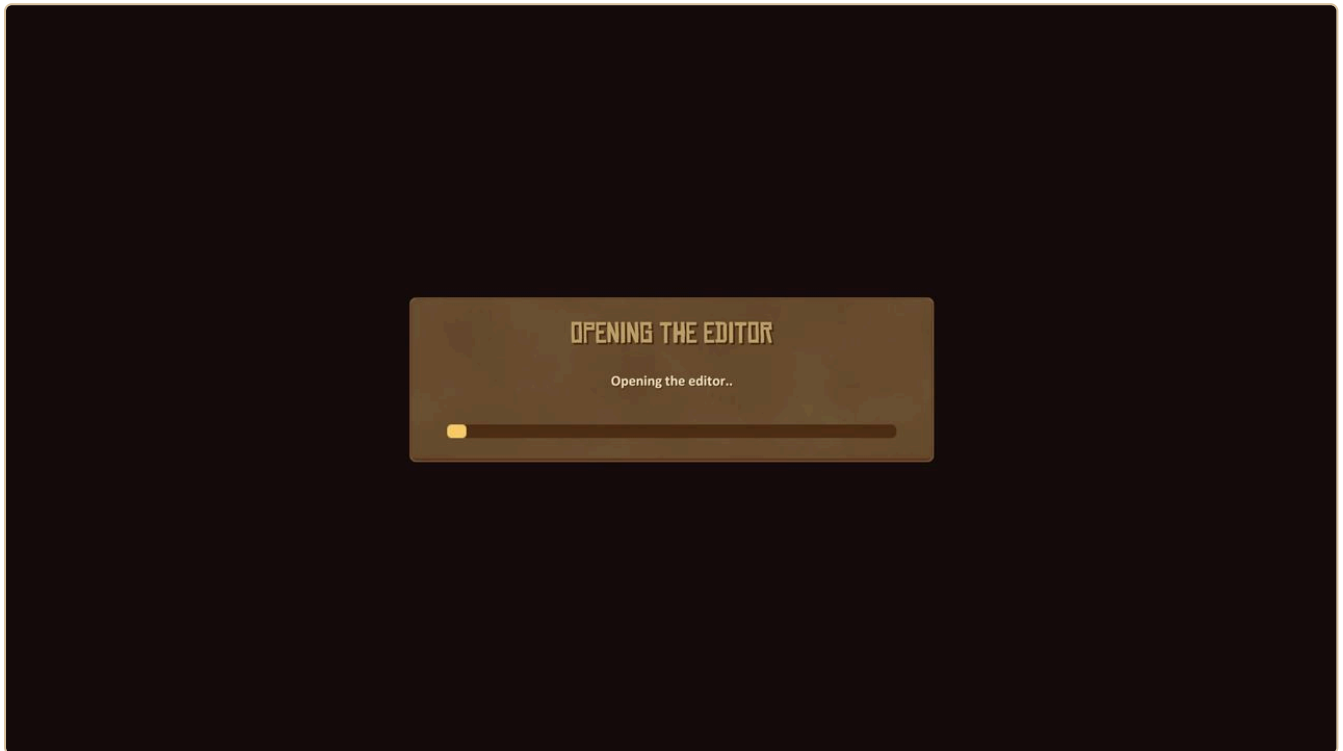
Press **J** to open the journal: the crew's **story items** (keys, maps, logs...) with their pictures, and every note you have read, on paper. Story items belong to the whole crew, like Raft's own quest items.



The journal: two story items at the top left, the pages read below, and the page "The keeper's note" open.

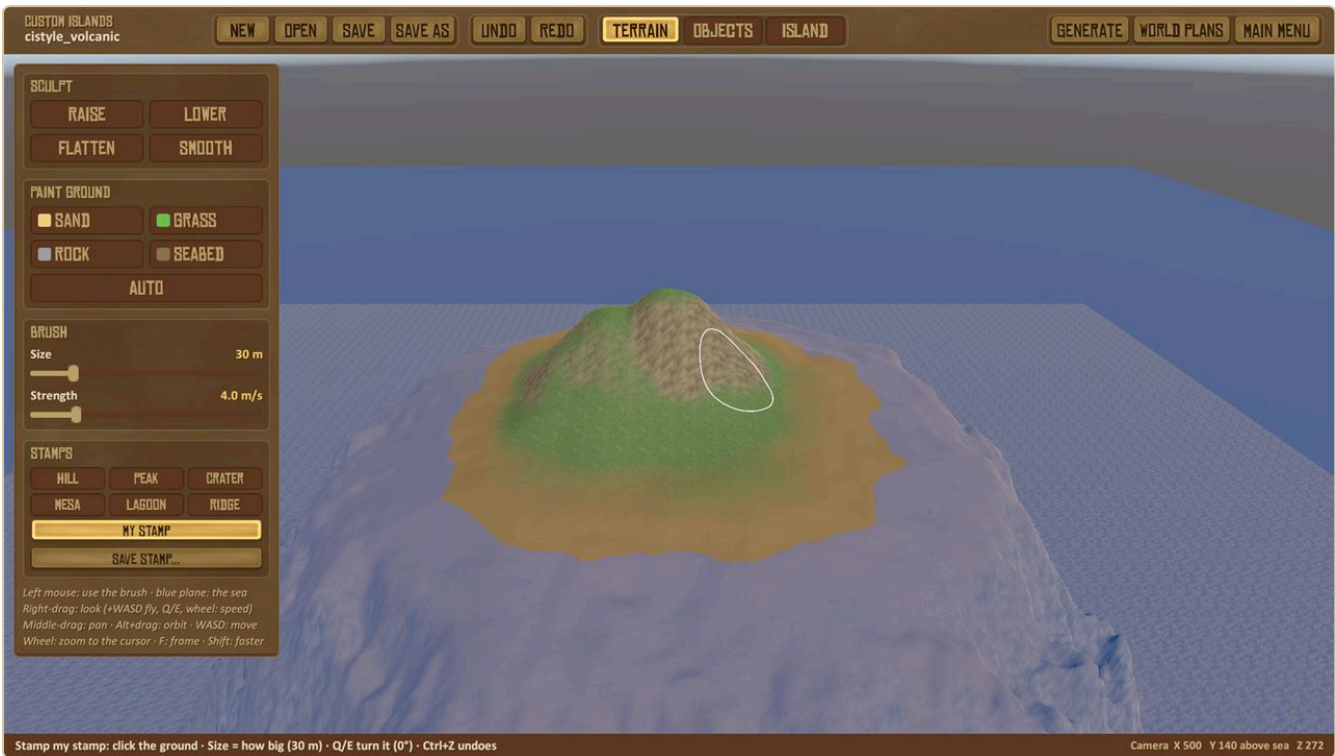
4. Building your own island: the editor

Click **EDITOR** in the main menu. A loading box shows what it is doing ("Opening the editor", then "Loading Raft's objects from its islands" with a bar) until the editor is ready: a few seconds the first time after starting Raft, less after that. The editor opens on the sea with an empty build area.



The box that covers the screen while the editor opens.

4.1 The screen



The editor on the Terrain tab.

- **Top bar:** New, Open, Save, Save as · Undo, Redo · the three tabs **Terrain, Objects, Island** (F1, F2, F3) · **Generate** (the island generator), **World plans, Main menu**. The island's name is at the top left.
- **Tool panel** (left): the tab's tools in bordered groups. The lit button is the one in use.
- **Status bar** (bottom): explains the tool, or the button under the mouse. On the right: where the camera is.
- **The blue plane is the sea.** Everything below it is under water in the game.

Moving the camera (like Unity's scene view):

Do this	To
Right-drag	look around; while held, WASD flies where you look, Q/E go down and up, the wheel sets the speed
WASD or arrows	move over the island at the same height
Middle-drag	pan (the ground follows the cursor)
Alt + left-drag	orbit around the selection, or the middle of the view
Wheel	zoom towards what is under the cursor
F	frame the selection, or the whole island
Shift	three times faster

Undo and redo everything with **Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**; save with **Ctrl+S**, open with **Ctrl+O**.

4.2 Shaping the land (Terrain tab)

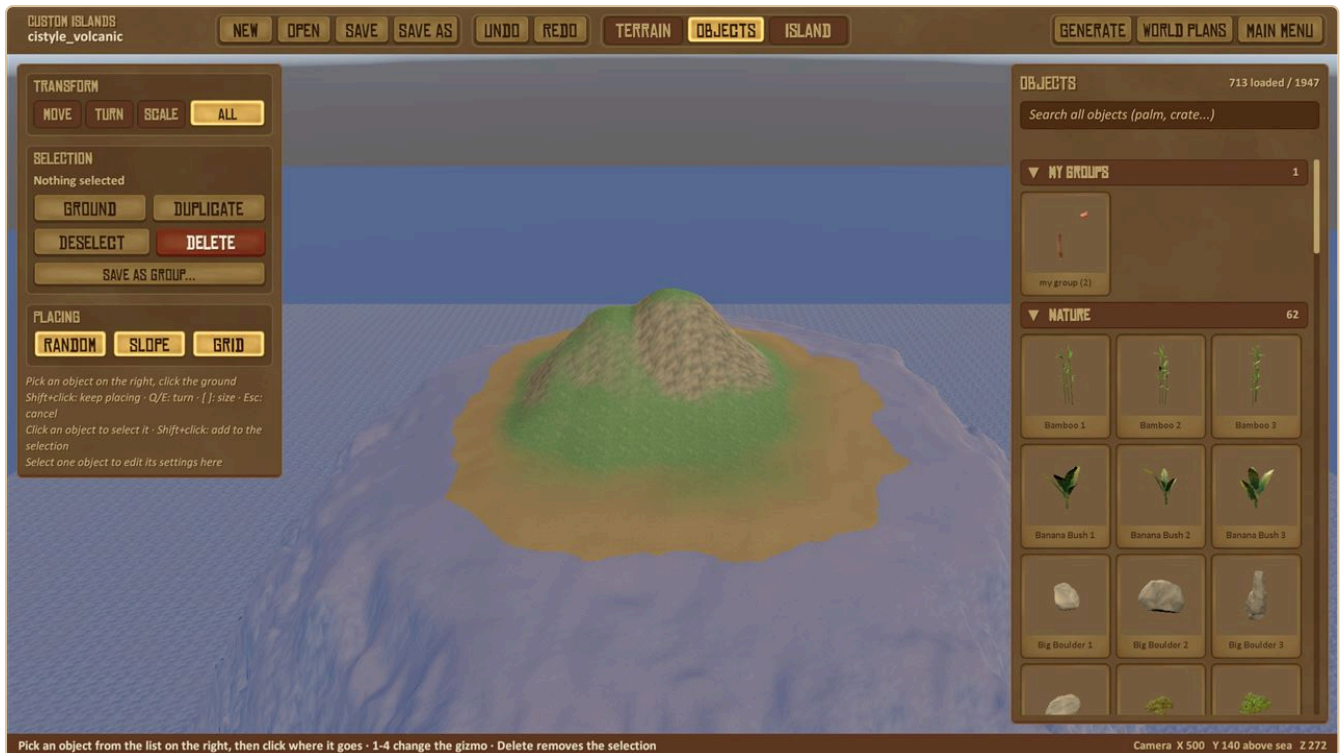
- **Sculpt: Raise, Lower, Flatten, Smooth.** Hold the left mouse button on the ground; the white ring shows the brush.
- **Paint ground:** the style's four textures (for a tropical island Sand, Grass, Rock, Seabed). **Auto** textures an area by its height and slope again.
- **Brush:** size and strength.
- **Stamps:** click the ground to put down a **Hill, Peak, Crater, Mesa, Lagoon** or **Ridge**, as big as the brush (Q/E turn it). **Save stamp...** keeps the land under the brush as a stamp of your own.

Island styles. On the Island tab, **Style** ◀ ▶ switches between Tropical, Snowy, Desert, Forest and Volcanic: the ground takes the style's textures, the paint buttons get its names, and the generator uses its plants and animals.



The same kind of island in four styles, as the generator makes them: tropical palms, snowy pines, desert red rock, forest birches.

4.3 Placing objects (Objects tab)



The Objects tab: the tools on the left, the object browser on the right (713 of 1,947 objects loaded).

The **object browser** on the right has **every object of Raft**, about 1,900, each with a picture: nature, harvestable trees and rocks, Raft's 88 building blocks (to build huts or your own abandoned rafts), everything else you can build on a raft, and the objects of Raft's story islands (they load the first time you open their category). **Search** finds objects in every category.

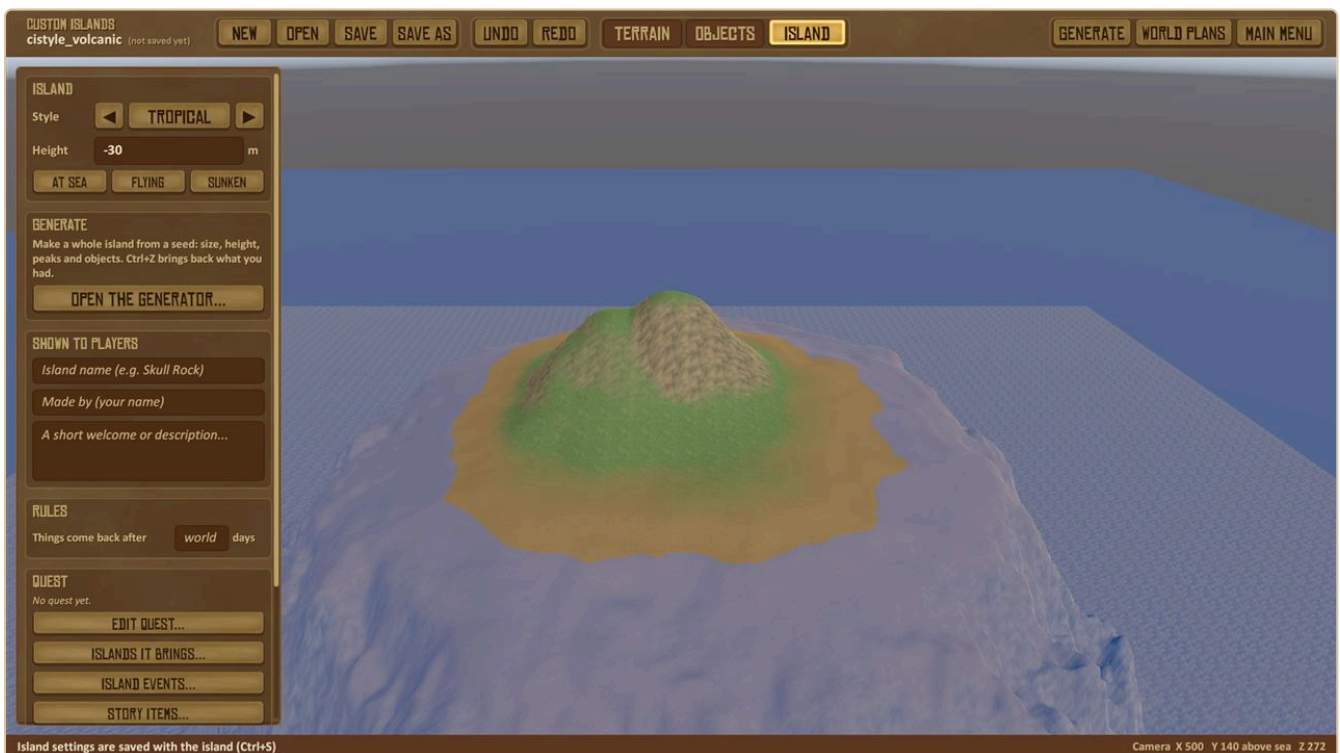
- **Place:** click an object in the browser, then click the ground. **Q/E** turn it, **[** and **]** resize it, **Shift+click** keeps placing, **Esc** stops.
- **Select:** click a placed object; **Shift+click** adds more.
- **Transform** (keys 1-4): Move, Turn, Scale or All, with the coloured handles.
- **Selection:** **Ground** drops the selection onto the terrain, **Duplicate** (Ctrl+D), **Deselect**, **Delete**.
- **Placing:** **Random** gives each placed object a random turn and size, **Slope** leans it with the ground, **Grid** snaps to Raft's 1.5 m building grid (Q/E then turn in 90° steps).
- **Groups:** select several objects and click **Save as group....** The group appears under **My groups** at the top of the browser, to place on any island.



A herd of two warthogs (the pink marker) and a sign. "My groups" in the browser holds two saved groups.

Selecting a single object shows its **inspector** in the tool panel: creature settings, a note, loot, a zone, a colour, behaviours (see [section 5](#)).

4.4 The Island tab



The Island tab: style, height in the world, the generator, the name players see, the island's rules and its quest.

- **Style** and **Height** in the world: **At sea** (0), **Flying** (60 m up) or **Sunken** (30 m under water), or any number. The editor always shows the island at sea level; the height applies in the game.

- **Shown to players:** the island's **name**, your name and a short welcome. Players see them as a banner.
- **Rules:** how many in-game days until chopped trees, picked items, killed animals, looted chests and fired zones come back on this island (empty = the world's setting, 0 = never). **Level up system** Off / On: see [section 9.6](#).
- **Quest, Islands it brings, Island events, Story items:** see [section 6](#).

4.5 The island generator

Generate (top bar) makes a whole island for you to start from. The **preview** map on the right follows every change; the line under it says how big the island is and how many objects it will get. The **seed** picks one island of all possible ones: the same seed and settings always give the same island. Every setting has a ? to hover. Generating replaces the island you have; **Ctrl+Z** brings it back.



The Normal tab: your presets, the style and layout, the size and height (with buttons for the size and height of Raft's own small island, large island and Balboa), peaks, hills and the coast.

- **Island:** the **style** and the **layout**: round, atoll, archipelago, sea stacks, plateau, marsh, crescent, twin peaks.
- **Size and height, coast and outline, land features:** peaks and their shape, hills, coast, bays, beach, cliffs, stretch, valleys, lakes, terraces, erosion.
- **Under water:** a **deep sea floor like Raft's** (a shelf about 10 m deep, then a drop-off) or a **shallow** one (a flat seabed 20 m down), the width of the shallow water, how steep the drop-off is, and the seabed (sand, rocky, or a reef ring).
- **Nature:** trees, bushes, rocks, beach things and harvestables, with quick buttons **None, Sparse, Like Raft, Dense** and **Jungle**. "Like Raft" places everything where Raft's own islands have it: a nearly bare beach, palms inland on grass, boulders on steep ground.
- **Life under water:** corals, sea vines, kelp, rocks, stones, ores, giant clams and sunken barrels, placed like around Raft's own islands.
- **Animals:** hostile creatures (the style's own, or the kinds you click), how tough (Easy, Normal, Hard, Boss), friendly animals to catch, sea creatures.

- **Loot:** how many loot boxes, their lowest and highest **tier** (1: planks and plastic ... 5: titanium, explosive goo, batteries), in the open or hidden.
- **My presets: Save these settings...** keeps them under a name; **Defaults** starts over.



Further down the Normal tab: the land features, the Under water group (Deep, like Raft) and the Nature quick buttons. Hovering a ? shows its help (here Stretch).



The bottom of the Normal tab: things to collect, sunken barrels, animals (the kinds to click, the toughness) and loot.

Can players reach it? Above the seed, a coloured line says whether a player arriving by raft can get onto the island: **Easy** (beaches, walk to the top), **Reachable**, **Possible but tricky** (a jump onto a low ledge),

Possible but unlikely, or Not from the raft without building (cliffs all around: players need stairs, a ladder or foundations). It is worked out with Raft's own player: how steep it can walk, how high it jumps.

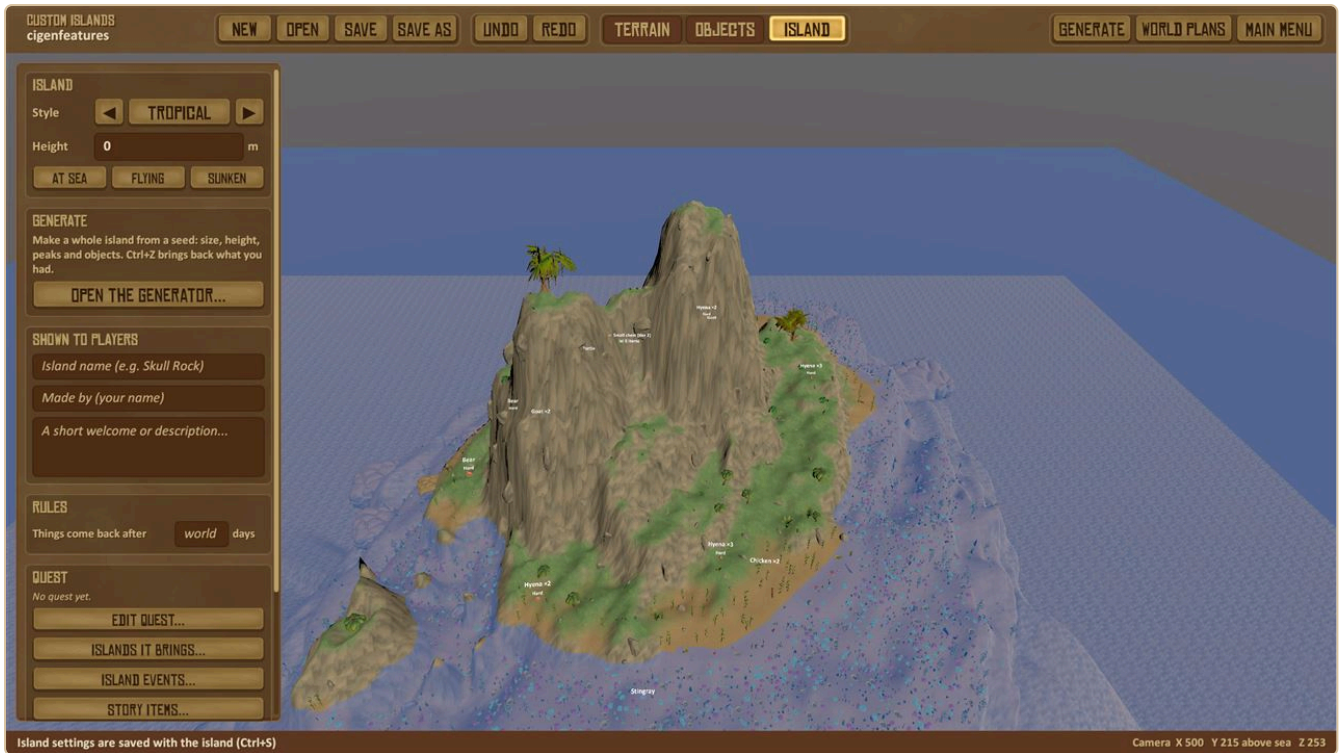


A cliff island: "Not from the raft without building: cliffs all around (the lowest ledge is 17 m above the water)."

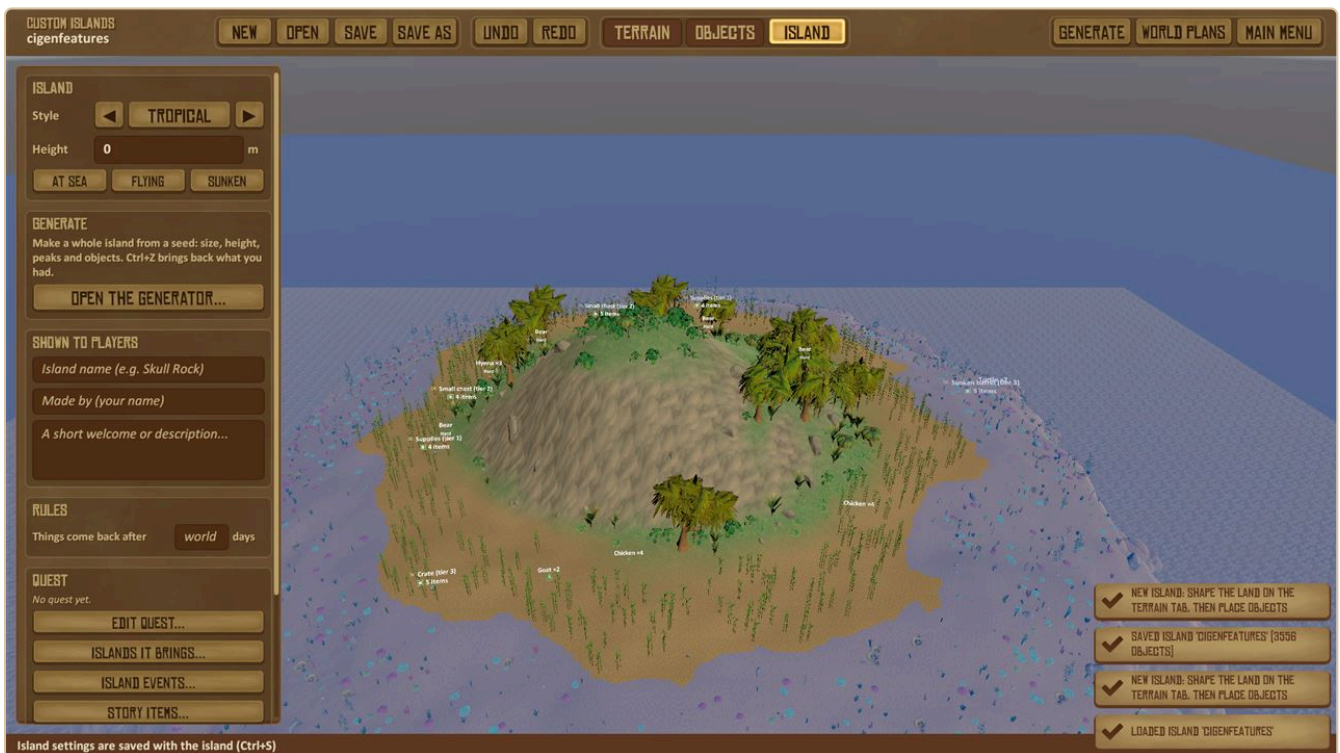
Randomize existing: click one of Raft's 33 islands (each has a picture). **Something new like it** makes a new island with its size, height and look; **A variation of it** starts from the island's own ground and reshapes it (stretch, mirror, roughen, coast, valleys...).



Randomize existing: Raft's islands, measured, with a picture each. Here a variation of "Big Island OG".



A variation made from one of Raft's big islands, opened in the editor.



A generated island in the editor, ready to change: its trees and bushes are ordinary objects you can move or delete.

The editor's view under water shows what a deep sea floor looks like:



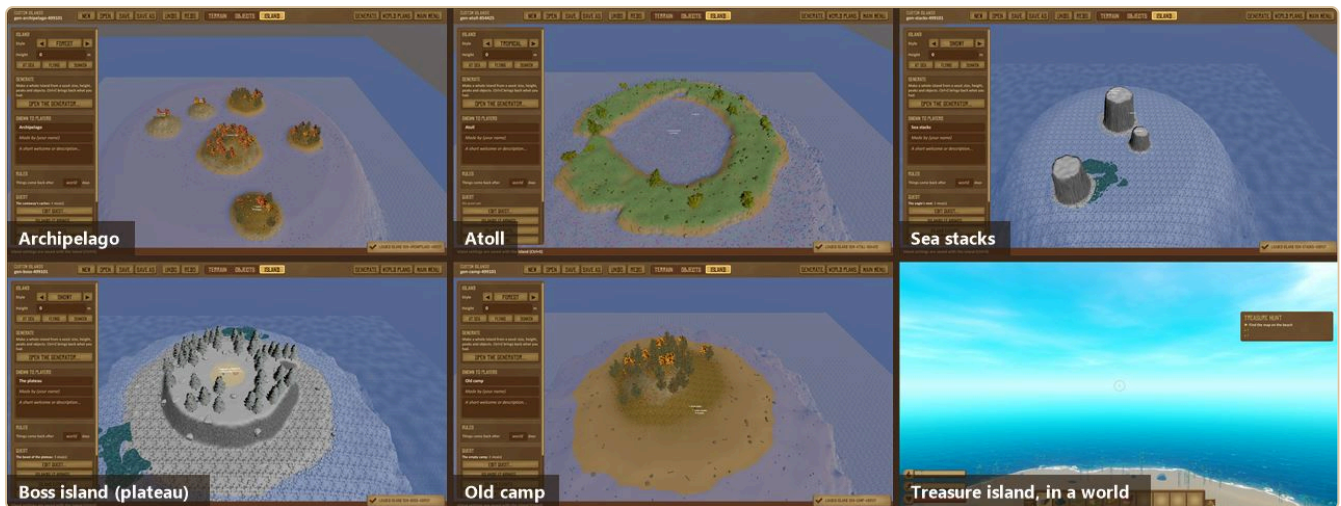
A generated island on the deep sea floor: the shelf and drop-off from above, the slope, the reef, the drop-off.

4.6 Ready-made islands (map types)

The generator's **Ready-made (with content)** tab makes whole islands with a story: chests, notes, creatures, zones and a quest, from a seed. Click a card, then **Make** (click twice): the island is saved as `gen-<type>-<seed>` and opened for you to change.



The Ready-made tab: plain islands of each style, and the map types with their content.



Some map types: an archipelago (a castaway's caches), an atoll, sea stacks (a chest on the tallest), a boss island, an old camp, and a treasure island in a world, its quest panel saying "Find the map on the beach".

Map type	What it is
Sandbar	A tiny island with a few palms and a small chest: a rest stop
Atoll	A ring of land around a shallow lagoon
Archipelago	Several islets; a castaway's note and three caches
Sea stacks	Steep rock pillars; a chest on top of the tallest (build your way up)
Boss island	A plateau with cliffs and a ramp; the arena wakes a boss bear
Volcano, swamp, frozen spire	A tall volcano with embers; low land with pools and mist; a snowy peak with a cache on top
Treasure island	A map in a bottle on the beach leads to the X and a treasure chest
Old camp	An abandoned camp with a notice board and supplies: a good first island of a story
Sunken island, sky island	Under water, with corals, sunken barrels and puffer fish; floating 45-90 m up with a cache
Wreck, ghost raft	No land: an abandoned raft of Raft's own blocks, floating like a real raft (the deck just above the water). A wreck has barrels to loot; a ghost raft is small, medium or large with a note, and the large ones are guarded by rats and screechers (9.4)
Oddities, boss lair, large island	The world randomizer's islands (section 9.3)

4.7 Saving and sharing

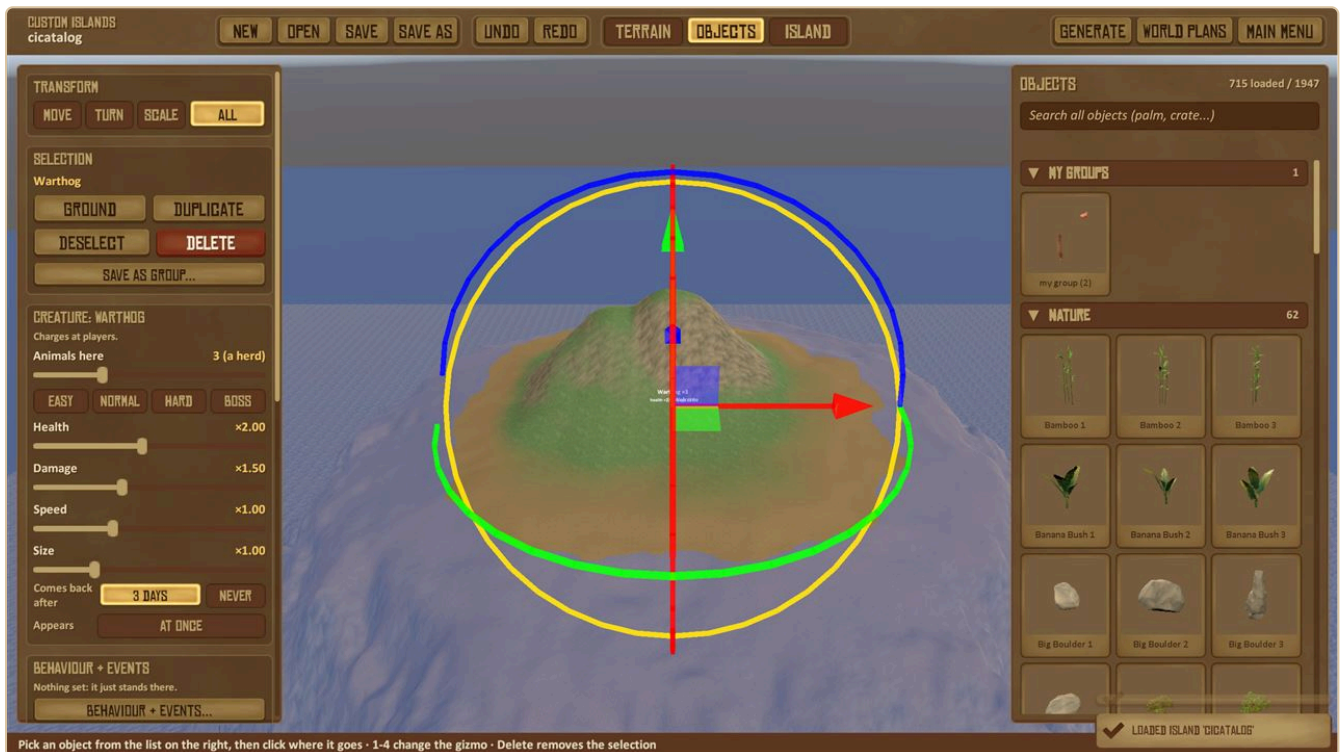
Save (Ctrl+S) saves straight away once the island has a name; **Save as** and **Open** show the **Islands** window: a name, the height in the world, and your saved islands (click = pick, double-click = open, Delete asks first).

5. Making islands come alive

Select an object to see its **inspector** in the tool panel. Everything here can be undone.

5.1 Creatures

Open **Animals: hostile**, **Animals: catchable** or **Sea creatures** in the browser and place an animal: warthog, pig, bear, polar bear, hyena, rats, roach, bee swarm, screecher; chicken, goat, llama; puffer fish, angler fish, turtle, stingray, dolphin, whale.



A warthog spot: a herd of 3, health $\times 2$, damage $\times 1.5$, comes back after 3 days, appears at once.

- **Animals here:** 1 to 8 (a herd).
- **Easy / Normal / Hard / Boss**, or set **health**, **damage**, **speed** and **size** yourself.
- **Comes back after** the regrow days, or **Never**.
- **Appears** at once, or **when a zone fires** (an ambush, see 5.4).
- **Colour** (every object): a swatch, the strength, or your own mix.

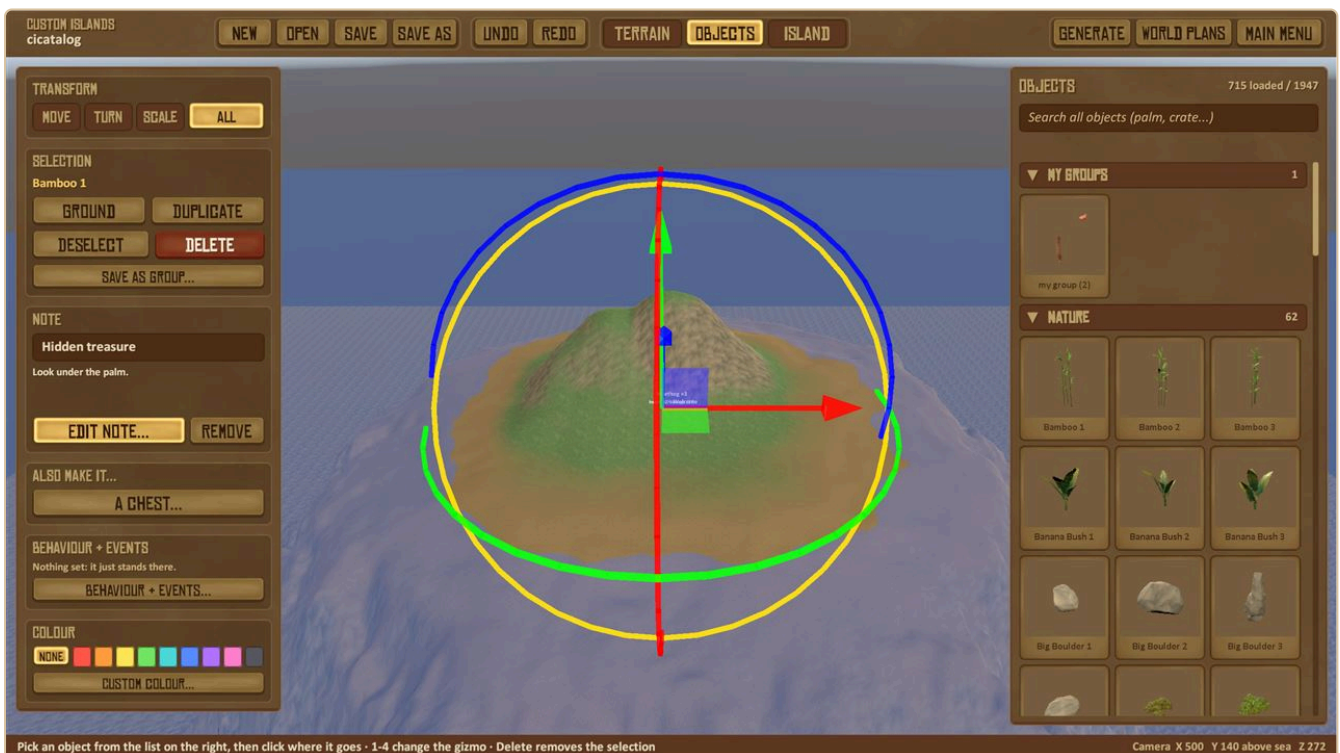
In the editor a creature is a coloured marker with its name, or Raft's real model once you have been in a world since starting Raft:



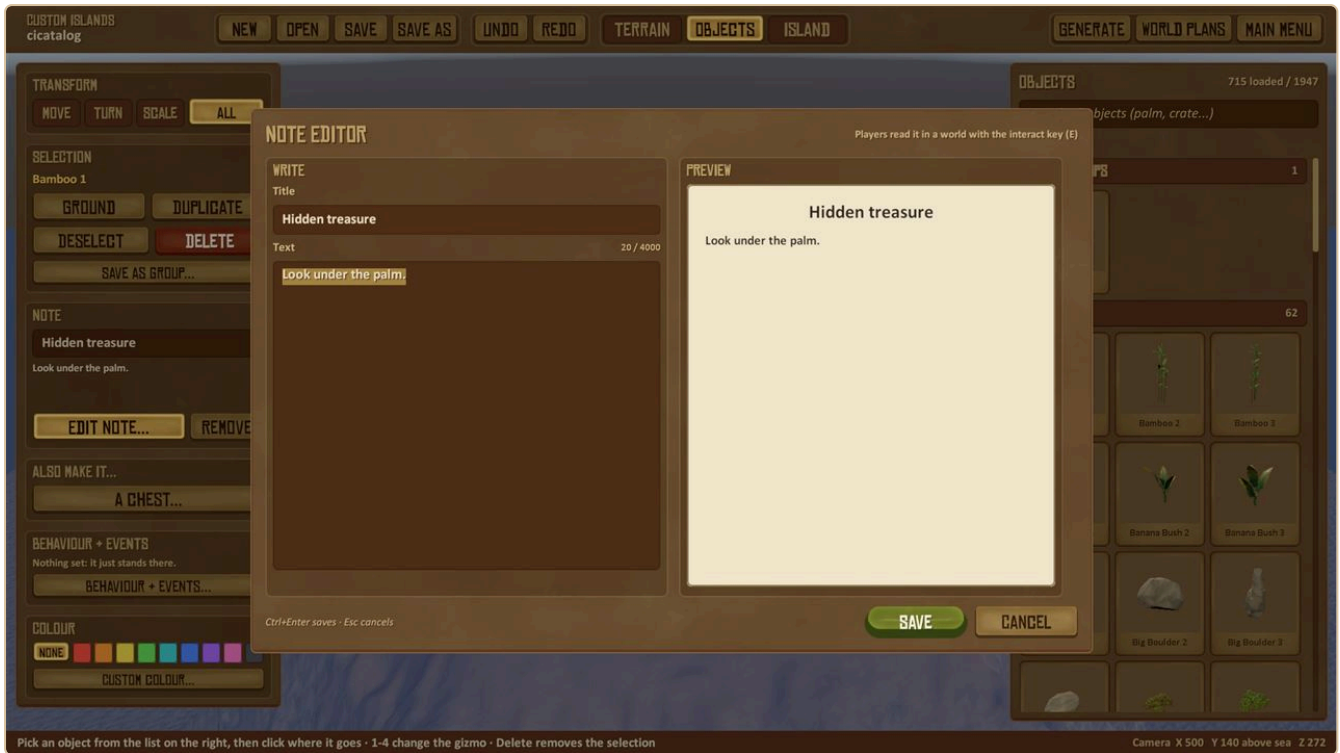
Creature spots with Raft's own models: a warthog, a llama, a bear, a chicken.

5.2 Notes and signs

"Notes & signs" has a paper, a bundle of papers, an open book, a sign, a notice board and a message in a bottle, and **any object can be made readable (Add a note to it...)**. A sign shows its note's title on its board.



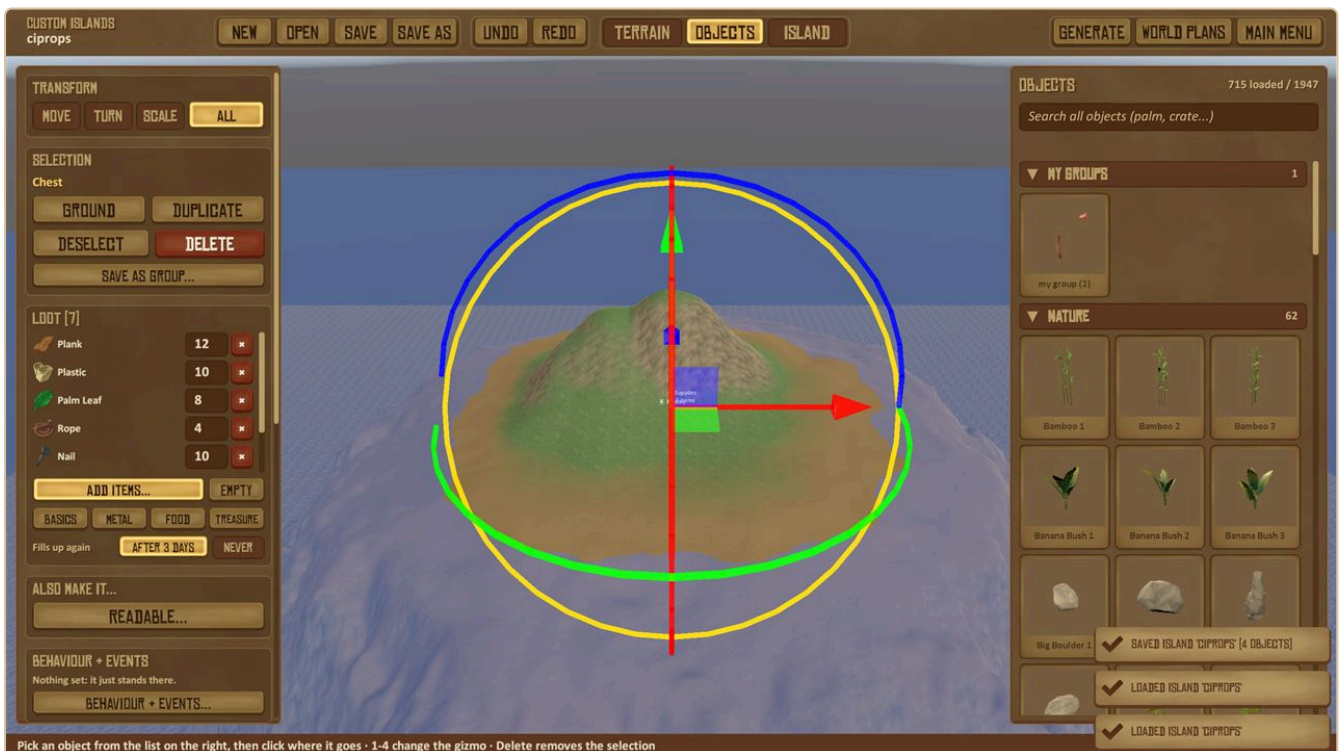
An object with a note: its title "Hidden treasure" and the start of the text.



The note editor: the title, the text (Enter starts a new line), and a preview of the paper players will see.

5.3 Chests and loot

"Loot & chests" has chests, a crate, a wooden box and barrels, and **any object can hold loot (A chest...)**.



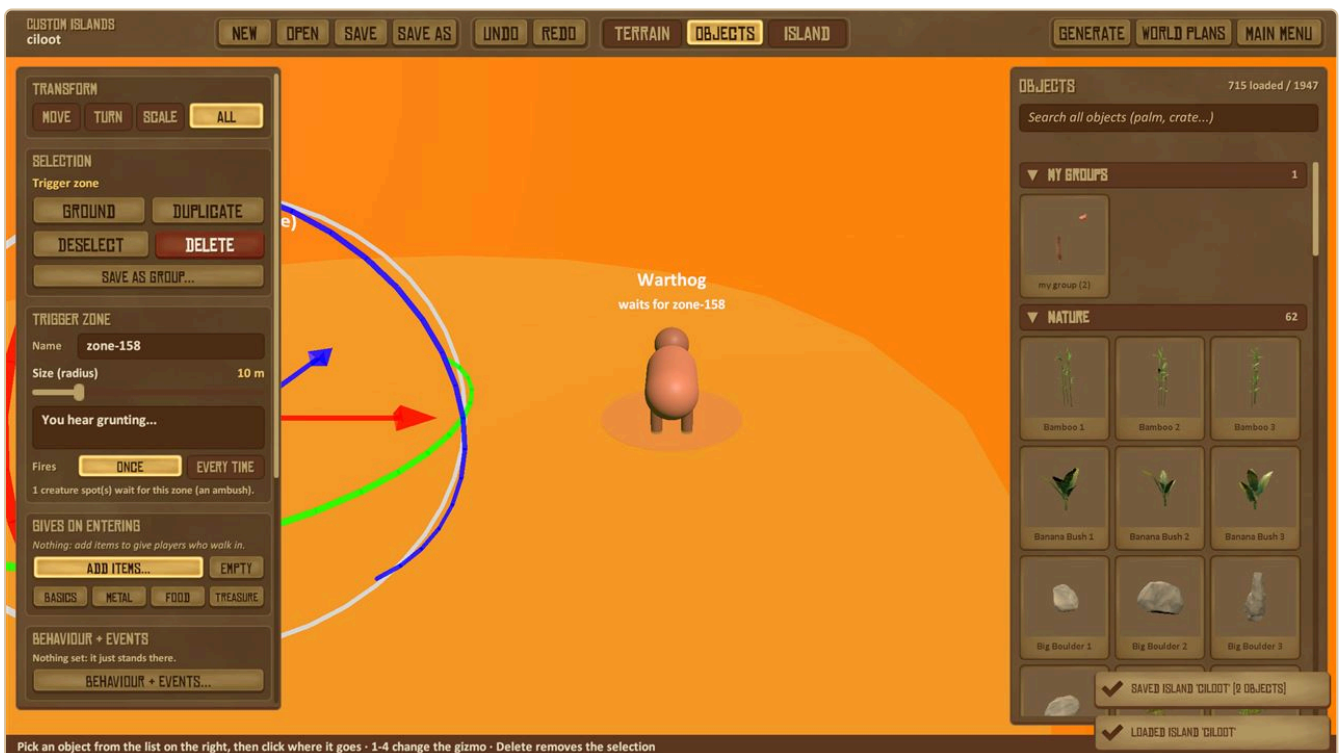
A chest's loot: planks, plastic, palm leaves, rope and nails. The Basics, Metal, Food and Treasure sets fill it quickly; it fills up again after 3 days, or never.



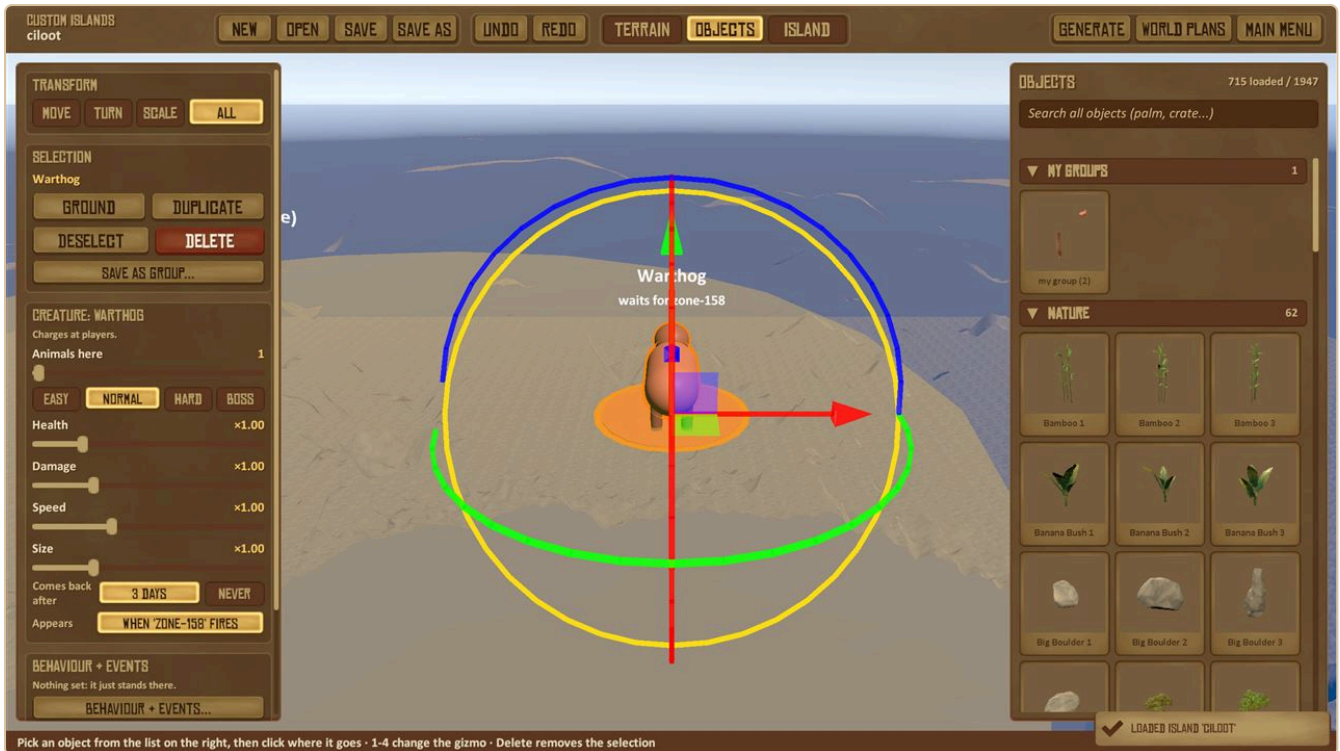
Add items...: every item of Raft with its picture and a search. Click an item to add one, again to add more.

5.4 Trigger zones and ambushes

A **trigger zone** ("Zones & triggers") is an invisible sphere. When a player walks in it shows your **message**, **gives items**, and wakes the creatures that wait for it. It fires **once** per world (again after the regrow days) or **every time**.



A trigger zone (the orange sphere): its name, size 10 m, the message "You hear grunting...", fires once, and one creature spot waits for it.

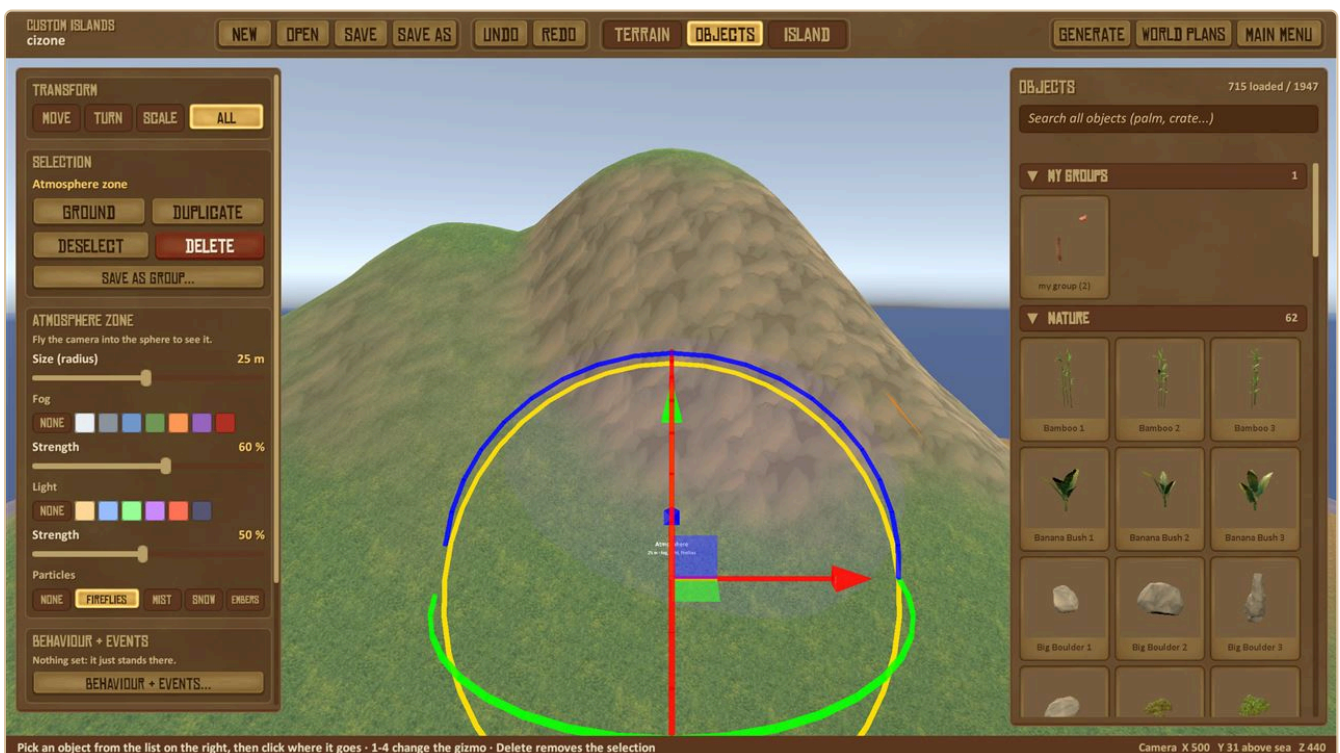


The warthog's **Appears** is set to "when zone-158 fires": its name tag says it waits. It appears the moment a player walks into the zone.

Invisible walls and ramps (also in "Zones & triggers") are solid in the world but not seen: block a path, fence an arena, or make a cliff climbable.

5.5 Atmosphere and sound

An **atmosphere zone** changes the fog colour, the light and adds particles (fireflies, mist, snow, embers) around a spot; a **sound zone** plays one of Raft's 500+ sounds while a player is inside, or once on entering.



An atmosphere zone: its size, fog colour and strength, light tint and strength, and particles (fireflies).



Fly the camera into the zone to see it: purple fog and fireflies.



Choose sound...: Raft's sounds with a search. ► listens, Use picks it.

6. Stories: quests, behaviours, story items

6.1 Quests

Island tab → **Edit quest...**: a title, an introduction (shown when players arrive), up to 10 steps in order, a reward and a closing message.



The quest "The lost camp": go to the camp, read the diary, open the supplies, chase off 2 warthogs. The reward is planks and rope, and when the quest is done it brings a saved island "Old camp" 700 m north, with a message and a name on the Receiver.

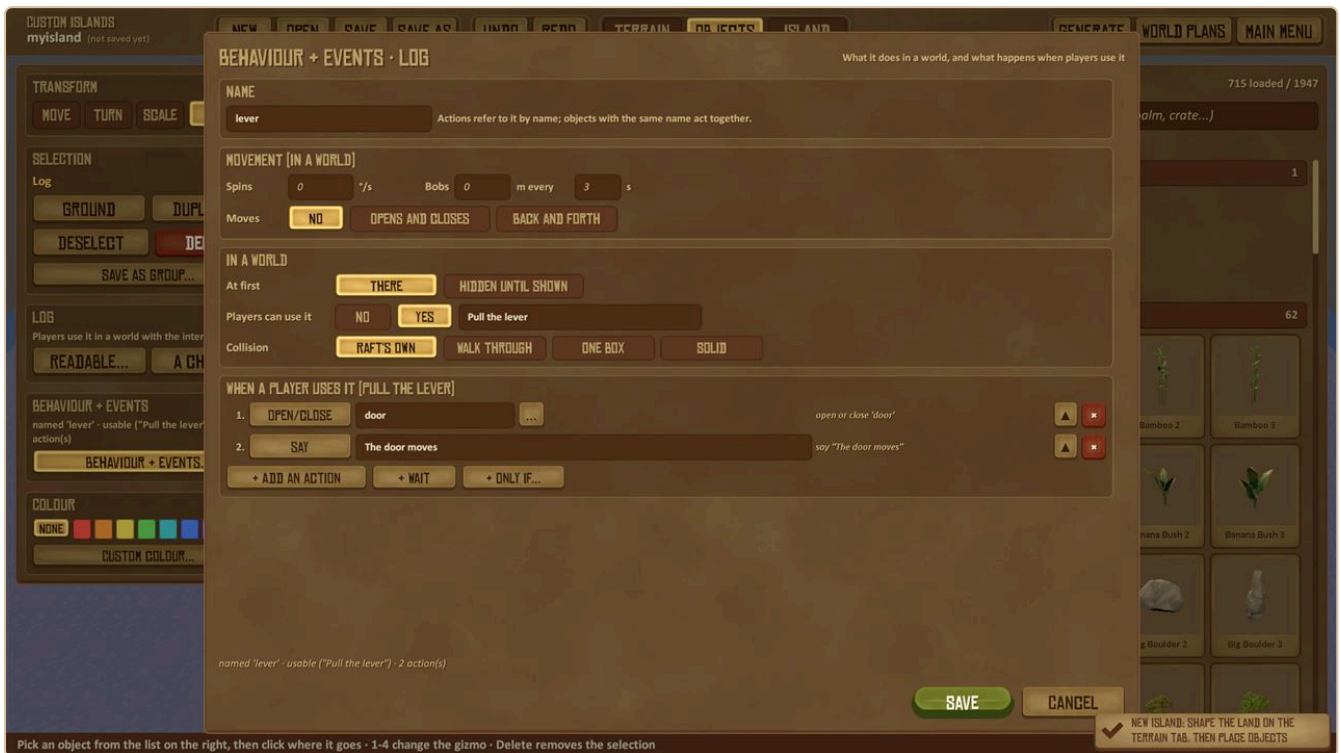
Steps: **go to** a trigger zone, **read** a note, **open** a chest, **defeat** or **catch** a number of animals, **collect** a number of a story item, **find** journal pages. Steps point at things on the island by name; the editor lists the names it knows.

6.2 Behaviour and events

Select any object → **Behaviour + events....** No code needed:

- **A name** that actions refer to (objects with the same name act together).
- **Movement**: spin, bob, move back and forth, or **open and close** like a door, gate, bridge or lift (with a Preview in the editor).
- **At first**: there, or **hidden until shown** (a hidden creature spot is an ambush).
- **Players can use it**: Raft's "press E" hint with your own text ("Pull the lever").
- **Collision**: Raft's own, walk through, one box, or solid.
- **When ... then**: when a player uses it, walks into a zone, reads a note, opens a chest, or all the animals of a spot are defeated → show / hide objects, open / close doors, say a message, give items, play a sound, teleport the player, send a signal, write a journal page, or **wait** some seconds first.

- **Only if**: the player **has** an item or story item (or **uses one up**, like a key), an object is open, closed, shown or hidden, a signal was sent, the quest reached a step. Turn a check round with **not**; ask for **all** or **any** of them. **Otherwise** say a message.

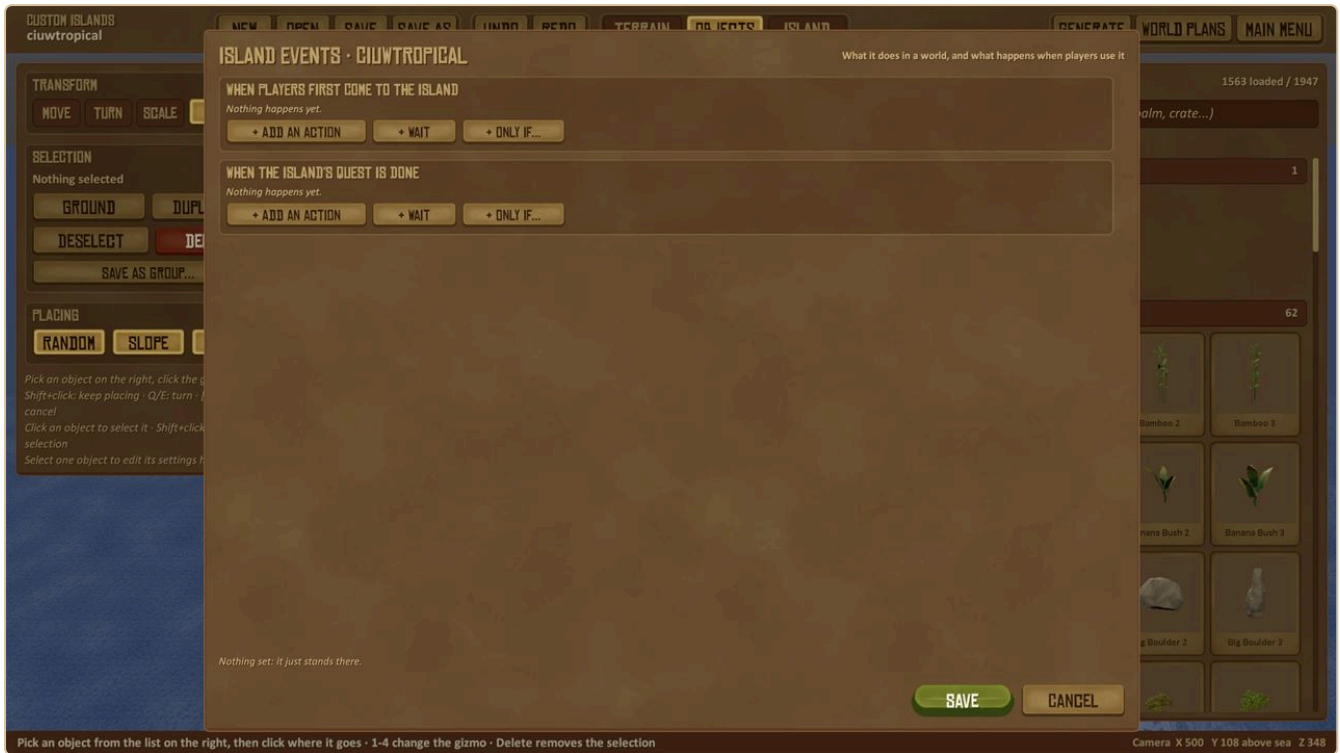


A log named "lever" that players can use ("Pull the lever"): it opens or closes the door and says "The door moves".



A door that opens only if the player has the story item "rusty key"; otherwise it says "It's locked. Maybe there's a key somewhere..."

Island events (Island tab): actions for when players first come to the island and when its quest is done.



Island events: what happens when players first come to the island, and when its quest is done.

6.3 Story items and story sets

Island tab → **Story items...**: keys, map pieces, logs... with a name, a description and a picture (Raft's quest item pictures or any Raft item). Chests, zones, quest rewards and "give" actions hand them out; "only if" checks ask for them; players find them in the journal (J).

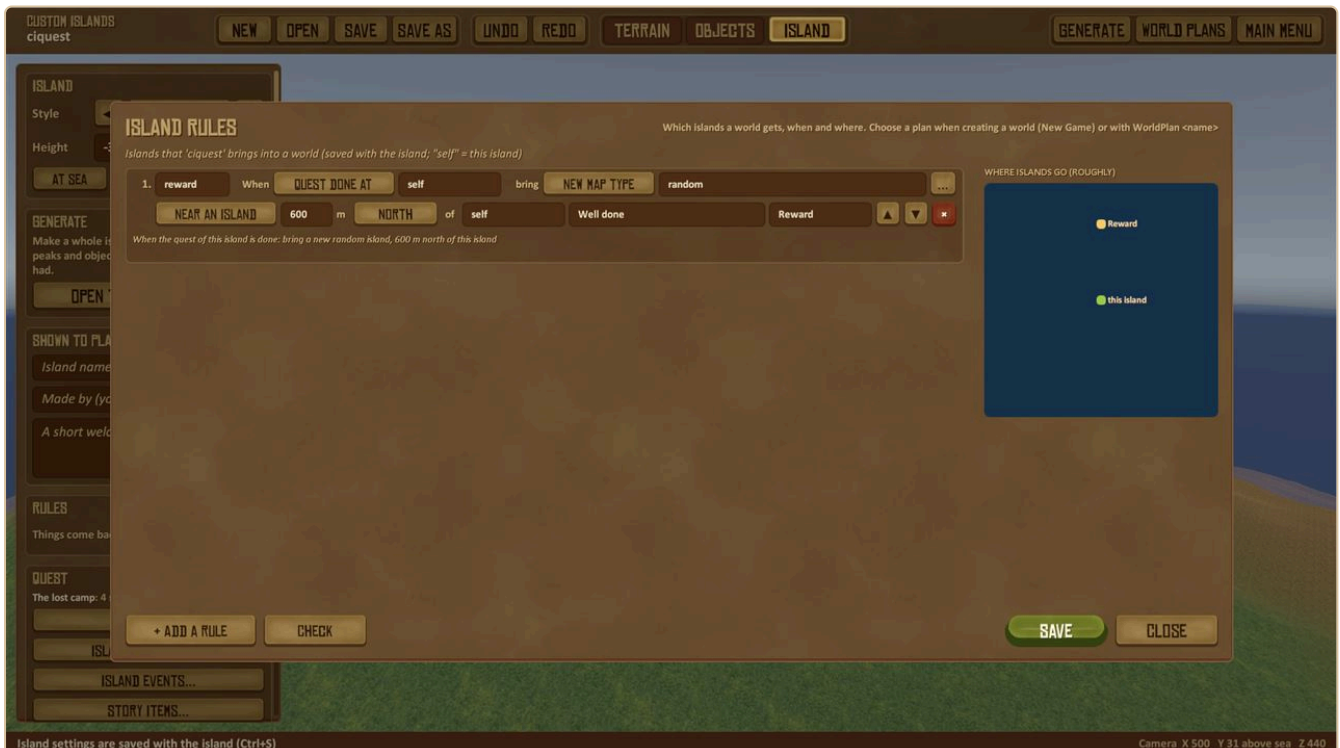
Story sets place a ready piece of a story in one step: **a locked door and its key** (in a chest with a note), **a trail of notes** leading to a hidden chest, **a treasure map** (a bottle gives the map; the X digs up a chest only for someone who has it), or **a locked chest** whose key is hidden in driftwood nearby.



The Story items window: the island's story items ("Old key") and the four story sets.

6.4 Islands that bring islands

Island tab → **Islands it brings...** gives the island its own rules: "when my quest is done", "when step 2 is done", "when zone X fires" or "when players first get here" → bring a saved island or a new island of a map type, how far and which way, with a message and a name on the Receiver. A chain of shared island files is a story on its own.



An island rule: when this island's quest is done, bring a new island of a random type 600 m north, with the message "Well done" and the name "Reward" on the Receiver. The map on the right sketches where islands go.

7. World plans: which islands a world gets

A **world plan** is a list of rules; each rule brings one island: **what** (a saved island, a new island of a map type, one from the spawn pool), **when** (the world starts, after N km, on day N, a quest done, a zone fired, players reach an island, a signal, after another rule), **where** (ahead of the raft, or near an island in a direction) and what players are **told**.

Choose a plan in the New Game box (**Custom Islands plan**). The mod comes with:

- **Random islands**: islands by chance while sailing (the default), **No custom islands**,
- **Island hopping**: an old camp, then each island you reach shows the way to the next,
- **Adventure**: a story where each quest leads to the next island, with a wreck and a sunken island on the way,
- **Growing sea**: random islands plus a special one every few km and days.

Make your own with **World plans** in the editor's top bar:



The Adventure plan: rules for a camp at the start, islets and a beast's plateau after the quests, a treasure island, a wreck after 2 km and a sunken island after 5 km. The map on the right sketches where they go.

New, Copy, Delete, Templates... (ready-made sets of rules), **random islands while sailing** on or off, **Check** (lists rules that can't work), **Save**. Plans are text files in `Mods\DynamicIslands\plans`. In a world, `WorldPlan` shows the plan and which rules have fired; the host can give the world another plan with `WorldPlan <name>`.

8. Playing together

Up to eight players (Raft's maximum). **Every player needs the mod.**

- **The host decides, for everyone:** the islands, the plan, the World settings (world rules, randomizer, extra options, which islands turn up while sailing; [section 9](#)), and the host's `spawnpool.txt` settings that change what players see (regrow days, Receiver dots, unload distance). A player's own files and last New Game choices never change the host's world, and only the host can change its settings.
 - **Players who join** (or join again, or after a restart) get all of it: the islands and any island files they don't have, what was chopped, picked, looted and fired, doors and levers, quests, the crew's journal, where they stood on an island, and the tough animals' health.
 - **Shared:** harvesting and pickups, chests (when several players open one at the same moment, the first gets it), zones, doors, quests and their rewards, story items, the journal. Things that move follow a clock all players share, so everyone sees them in the same place.
 - **What grows back** is the host's decision: things come back when the island loads on the host after the regrow days; a player who has the island loaded sees it the next time it loads there.
 - **Joining:** use Steam's "Join Game" on a friend (Raft's own Join World list is empty in this Raft version).
 - **Someone else hosts next time:** Raft keeps the world on the host's PC. Copy its folder (`%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\User\User_<Steam id>\World\<world name>`) to the new host's PC, into their own `User_<Steam id>\World`. The custom islands, what was used, quests, the journal, everyone's levels and the world's rules come along: the folder carries the mod's copy (`CustomIslands.txt`), and every player who joined keeps one too. Islands you only have from joining are used from their downloaded copies.
 - **Levels** (with the level up system on): each player's own, kept by the host and back when they join again; the host works out everyone's EXP, and each player sees the others' levels under their names.
-

9. World settings: rules and extra systems

Everything in this section is **optional and separate from island building**: switches that change how a whole world plays, for players who know Raft well and want it different. None of them is needed to make or meet custom islands, and a world where they are all left alone plays as plain Raft plus your islands.

- **World rules** (9.2): tougher or softer monsters, a dearer build menu.
- **World randomizer** (9.3): a normal Raft world made different every time: colours, alphas, finds, odd islands, bosses.
- **Extra options** (9.4): scrambled blueprints, the story islands in a new order, ghost rafts, private storages.
- **Islands while sailing** (9.5): which of your islands a world may meet.
- **The level up system** (9.6): EXP and stat points, switched on by an island rather than in the window.

All of them belong to the world: chosen when it is created, saved with it, the same for every player (the host's), and they come along when the world moves to another host ([section 8](#)).

9.1 The World settings window

Everything else the mod lets you choose for a new world is in one window, in four groups. Each part has a ? or an explanation. **Raft's own** puts every setting back to plain Raft; **Done** closes the window.



The World settings window: the world rules and the world randomizer on the left, the extra options on the right.

Group	What it does
World rules: monster difficulty	How tough monsters are in this world: Timid, Normal, Fierce, Savage or Nightmare (see section 9.2)

Group	What it does
World rules: build cost	How many more materials the build menu costs: Raft's own up to +100 %, rounded up
World randomizer	A normal Raft world made different: Off, Light, Normal or Wild, and which parts take part (click a part to switch it off; see section 9.3)
Extra options	More ways to play Raft again, for players who know it by heart: each switched ON or off with its own button (below)
Islands while sailing	Which of your islands (and which kinds of new islands) turn up by chance while you sail in this world: CHOOSE ISLANDS... opens the list (below)

Raft's own sets monsters to Normal, the build cost to Raft's own, the randomizer to Off and every extra option to off (it leaves the island list alone). The line at the bottom of the window sums up what the world will get. Nothing is final until you click **Create** in the New Game box.

In a world the host can change every group with a console command (F10); every player gets the change at once:

Group	Show it	Change it (host)
Monster difficulty	Monsters	Monsters savage
Build cost	BuildCost	BuildCost 25
World randomizer	Randomizer	Randomizer wild, Randomizer -alphas +bosses
Extra options	WorldOptions	WorldOptions +ghostrifts -privatetestorage
Islands while sailing	WorldIslands	WorldIslands -<island>, WorldIslands +<island>, WorldIslands all

9.2 World rules: monster difficulty and build cost

Monster difficulty

Level	Monsters' health	Damage they deal to players
Timid	×0.75	×0.75
Normal	×1 (as Raft made them)	×1
Fierce	×1.25	×1.25
Savage	×1.5	×1.5
Nightmare	×2	×2

Monsters are the animals that fight players, on Raft's islands and custom ones: sharks, warthogs, bears, polar bears, screechers, puffer fish, rats, hyenas, bees, angler fish, the butler bots and the bosses. Left as Raft has them: puffer fish damage, and everything about Bruce and your raft (his bites on it, how often he comes, how soon he comes back). In Peaceful and Creative monsters can't hurt you, so only their health changes.

Build cost

Everything in the **build menu** (the hammer's foundations, floors, walls, roofs, stairs...) costs **0-100 % more**, always rounded up: at +50 % one plank becomes two, two become three, three become five. Removing a block gives back half of what it cost (as in Raft), and repairing and reinforcing cost more too. The crafting menu (Tab) costs the same as in Raft.

Both rules are the host's for every player, also players who join later. The host can change them in a world: **Monsters savage**, **BuildCost 25**. At the main menu the same commands set the choice for the next new world.

9.3 The world randomizer

The randomizer makes a **normal Raft world** play out differently every time, with or without custom islands, and without touching Raft's story (the radio tower, Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point, Temperance and Utopia stay as they are). Choose it in the World settings window (New Game box, **WORLD SETTINGS...**): **Off**, **Light**, **Normal** or **Wild**, and which parts take part. The level sets how often things happen:

	Light	Normal	Wild
Animals in another colour	about 15 %	about 30 %	about 55 %
Alpha fighters (sharks)	about 3 % (6 %)	about 6 % (12 %)	about 12 % (22 %)
An oddity island (after the first 1.5 km)	about every 12 km	about every 7 km	about every 4 km
A large island (after the first 3 km)	about every 20 km	about every 10 km	about every 7 km
A boss lair (after the first 4 km)	about every 40 km	about every 20 km	about every 12 km

The parts (all on unless you click one off):

Part	What you'll find
Colours	Animals and sharks (Bruce too) now and then in another colour: charcoal, ash, rust, moss, frost, night... and rarely a gold shark
Animals	More animals on Raft's islands, now and then puffer fish on the reef
Alphas	Rare bigger, darker alpha warthogs, bears, hyenas and screechers (3× health), and a huge Big Bruce . A banner warns you. Killed, they drop a trophy head , meat and leather
Loot	Some of the crates and giant clams on Raft's islands lie in other places; now and then extra crates and barrels
Finds	A treasure hunt (a map in a bottle on the beach leads to a buried chest), an abandoned camp , a castaway's stash , and on Raft's big islands a den with a guard and a hoard
Oddities	Small odd islands while you sail: a van, a caravan, a crashed plane, a stranded boat, a hermit's shack, a statue, rocket debris, a hut of raft blocks
Bosses	Now and then a boss lair : climb the plateau and a named beast (Old Ironhide, Frostfang, Ashmaw, the Tusk King, the Laughing One) wakes with two guards

Part	What you'll find
Large	Now and then a large island as big as Raft's big ones, with a made-up name, animals, hidden loot, scenes from the quest islands and a den



The oddity islands. Each has loot, a note and a banner with its name when you arrive.



Large islands: tropical or snowy, with warthogs and animals to catch, a made-up name ("Coral Cay") and a den whose guard wakes when you walk in ("Something moves in the dark...").



Scenes on large islands, made from the props of Raft's quest islands, each with a chest and a note.



The Finds part can put a den on one of Raft's own big islands: a rock outcrop with a den inside, a guard and a hoard.

Changing it later: Randomizer (F10) shows what it does in your world; the host can change it, for example Randomizer wild or Randomizer -alphas. Everything follows from the world's seed, so every player sees the same colours, alphas and crates.

9.4 Extra options

More ways to play Raft again. Each option has its own button in the window's right column, switched **ON** or off, with an explanation under it. They can be combined freely.

Scrambled blueprints

The blueprints lying on Raft's story islands (Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa...) are swapped with each other, so each is found on another story island than usual. The pickup's name tells you which blueprint

you'll get. The pairs come from the world's seed: every player finds the same blueprint in the same place, and no blueprint stays in its own place. What the story needs is **never moved**: the Receiver and antenna, the steering wheel, the engine and its fuel, the machete, the zipline and the headlight, so the story can always be finished. Only what a pickup gives changes; which pickups there are, and which were taken, stays Raft's. Switching the option off (`WorldOptions -blueprints`) puts what is left in the pickups back to Raft's own.

Story islands in a new order

Radio Tower, Vasagatan, Balboa, Caravan Town, Tangaroa, Varuna Point and Temperance come in a shuffled order. Raft has no fixed places for them: each appears near the raft when the Receiver is tuned to a frequency a note unlocked. With the option on, the Receiver's first frequency leads to the new order's first island, and the note you find there to the next. The frequency numbers written on the notes follow; the notes' text still speaks of Raft's own order. **Utopia**, the ending, stays last. Each story island holds its own keys and parts, so any order can be finished.

Ghost rafts

Abandoned rafts of Raft's own blocks lie on the sea and come up ahead while you sail: none in the first 1.5 km of a world, then about one every 3 km. Three sizes:

Size	How often	What is on it
Small	about 6 in 10	A few foundations, a barrel and a message in a bottle
Medium	about 3 in 10	A hut of walls and a roof, a barrel and a box, a captain's log, sometimes a rat or two
Large	about 1 in 10	A wide raft with huts, pillars and a lookout, a hoard chest and barrels, guarded by rats on the deck and screechers circling above

You can walk on their decks (they float like a real raft, the deck just above the water) and loot what is on them. Every player sees the same ghost raft: the host brings it, as an island of the map type `ghostraft`.

Private storages

A storage opens only for the player who built it. Looking at someone else's shows whose it is instead of "Open", and **E** does nothing. Storages built while the option was off (or before this version of the mod) have no builder and open for everyone. The host keeps who built which with the world, so it stays after saving, loading and joining again.

For every player

Every player in the world gets the host's options, also when joining later. The host can change them in a world: `WorldOptions` (F10) shows them, `WorldOptions +ghostrafts -privatestorage` switches them.

9.5 Islands while sailing

With the plan **Random islands** (or a plan with random islands on), islands turn up by chance while you sail: every island you have saved or downloaded, plus brand-new generated ones and the map types listed in `spawnpool.txt` (section 10). The group **Islands while sailing** in the World settings window chooses which of them this world may meet. Its button, **CHOOSE ISLANDS...**, says how many take part (all 42, or 30 of 42) and opens the list:

- one row per island or kind of island, each with a **tick box**: your own islands by name (with their size and date), **New ... islands** for each map type (a new sandbar, wreck, atoll... each time) and **Brand-new generated islands**;
- untick the ones this world shouldn't have;
- the **search** field narrows the list (type part of a name), and **Tick shown** / **Untick shown** do every row shown, for example all your test islands at once.

Only what you untick is kept, so islands you make or download later join older worlds too, unless you untick them when you make a new world. The choice belongs to the world (saved with it, so it stays when another player hosts the world later), and the next new world starts from it. In a world the host can change it with `WorldIslands -<island> / +<island> / all`; `WorldIslands` alone shows the list.

Islands that a quest, an island's rule or a world plan brings (section 6.4, section 7) come anyway: the list is only about islands by chance.

9.6 The level up system

Levels come to a world with an island made with **Level up system: On**. You switch it on in the editor's **Island** tab (Rules), or with the generator's **Level up** choice. Once such an island has appeared in a world, levels are on there for good, for every player. A world without one plays as Raft always does.



The switch in the Island tab's Rules.

Earning EXP

Hit a monster and the EXP it gave you floats up over it. Each hit gives the share of the monster's EXP that it took off its health, so killing it gives all of it. If you fight it together with a friend, each of you gets your own share. Chickens, goats, llamas, turtles, stingrays, dolphins, whales and people give nothing.



A hit on a warthog: +2 EXP.

Tougher monsters that bite harder are worth more, measured against Bruce the shark, who is worth **20 EXP**:

Monster	EXP	Monster	EXP
Bruce (shark)	20	Bear	13
Warthog	13	Polar bear	15
Screecher	12	Hyena	7
Puffer fish	9	Rat	7
Mama bear (Balboa)	67	Hyena boss	40

An island's own Hard or Boss animals are worth more than Raft's plain ones.

From level	EXP to the next	About
1 → 2	100	5 sharks
2 → 3	200	10 sharks
3 → 4	400	20 sharks
4 → 5	600	30 sharks
then	200 more each level	10 more sharks each level

Levelling up and spending points

A box shows when you reach a new level. **Click it** (in a menu, where the mouse is free) or press **K** to spend your points. The **EXP bar** is one more of Raft's own stat bars, above thirst, hunger and health: a gold star on its badge, a gold fill, the level on the left and the EXP to the next level on the right. It glows for a moment

when you earn EXP. A + after the level means points are waiting. While Raft's inventory (**Tab**) is open, a **Stats** button sits next to the bar.



Level 2: two stat points to spend. The EXP bar is at the bottom left.



The EXP bar with its star, styled like Raft's thirst, hunger and health bars, and the Stats button while the inventory is open.

Every level gives **2 stat points**. Each point makes a stat **1% better**, and a stat takes at most 10 points (+10%):

Stat	A point makes it
Walk speed, Run speed, Swim speed	1% faster
Jump height	Jump 1% higher
Damage	1% more damage to monsters, with every weapon
Health	1% more maximum health

Stat	A point makes it
Hunger, Thirst	Drain 1% slower
Oxygen	Breath lasts 1% longer under water



The stats page (K): the level, the EXP, the monsters you defeated, and the nine stats. + puts a point in, - takes it back while the page is open.

All 90 points are there at level 46. After that the levels go on, without points.

Playing together: each player has their own level, and the host keeps it with the world. A player who joins again gets theirs back. The host works out everyone's EXP, so a monster is worth the same to everybody. Other players see a small gold **Lv 5** under your name.

10. Settings files

In `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\`. Text files: open them with Notepad. They explain themselves, and changes are picked up while the game runs.

`spawnpool.txt` (islands that appear on their own; the host's counts):

Setting	Default	What it does
<code>chancePerKm</code>	0.25	Chance that an island appears for each km the raft sails (0 to 1)
<code>minSpacing</code>	800	Metres kept between custom islands
<code>spawnDistanceMin</code> , <code>spawnDistanceMax</code>	250, 350	How far ahead of the raft an island appears
<code>unloadDistance</code>	800	Islands further away are unloaded (and come back when you return)
<code>regrowDays</code>	3	In-game days until harvested things grow back (0 = never)
<code>showOnReceiver</code>	1	Custom islands as green dots on Raft's Receiver (0 = no)
<code>defaultPlan</code>	Random islands	The plan new worlds get when none is chosen
<code>generated</code>	1	How often a brand-new generated island is picked (0 = never)
<code>generatedStyles</code>	all five	The styles generated islands can have
<code>generatedFlyingChance</code>	0.1	The chance a generated island flies
<code><island name> <weight></code>	<code>* 1</code>	Which of your islands take part (<code>*</code> = every island not listed; weight 0 leaves one out)
<code>type:<map type> <weight></code>	sandbar, wreck, atoll, sunken	Map types that take part

Other files:

File	What it holds
<code>*.island</code>	Your islands (copy one to share it)
<code><name>_<hash>.island</code>	Islands downloaded from a host
<code>plans*.plan</code>	World plans
<code>world_rules.txt</code> , <code>randomizer.txt</code>	Your last World settings choices (monsters, build cost, extra options, islands left out; the randomizer), the start for the next new world

File	What it holds
worlds\<world>.txt	Each world's custom islands and their state (what was used, quests, journal, levels, settings); the world's own folder carries a copy, CustomIslands.txt
groups\, stamps\	Your saved object groups and terrain stamps
generator_presets\	Your generator presets (Save these settings...)
notice.txt	That you folded the alpha box, for this version of the mod

11. Console commands

Press **F10** for RML's console.

Command	Where	What it does
SpawnIsland <name> [distance] [height]	World, host	An island ahead of the raft (default 250 m)
RemoveIsland <name> / RemoveIsland all	World, host	Removes custom islands
ListIslands / ListSpawned	Anywhere / world	Your saved islands / the world's custom islands with their distance
SpawnPool	World	Which islands appear on their own, and how often
CustomIslandsAuto on / off	World, host	Automatic islands on or off for this world
WorldPlan / WorldPlan <name>	World	The world's plan and its rules / give it another plan (host)
Randomizer / Randomizer <off/light/normal/wild> [-part] [+part]	World	What the randomizer does here / change it (host)
WorldOptions / WorldOptions +option -option	World	The world's World settings / change them (host; blueprints, storyorder, ghostrafts, privatestorage)
WorldIslands / WorldIslands - <island> / +<island> / all	World	Which islands turn up by chance while sailing in this world / leave one out, let it take part again, all of them (host)
Monsters / Monsters <level>	World or main menu	The monster difficulty / change it (host; at the main menu: the next new world)
BuildCost / BuildCost <0-100>	World or main menu	The build cost / change it (host; at the main menu: the next new world)
LoadEditor	Main menu	Opens the editor

The editor's own commands (SaveIsland , GenerateIsland , SetStyle ...) are in the [README](#).

12. Questions and problems

No islands appear while I sail. Run `SpawnPool`: are automatic islands on, and is the pool empty? The plan may be "No custom islands" (`WorldPlan`). Islands appear only where there is room: near Raft's own islands they wait until the sea is clear. `SpawnIsland <name>` places one right away.

K does nothing, and there is no level bar. The level up system is off in this world. It comes on once an island made with **Level up system: On** has appeared in the world (see [section 9.6](#)).

A friend's storage won't open. The world has **Private storages** on (9.4): a storage opens only for the player who built it. The host can switch it off with `WorldOptions -privatestorage`.

The Receiver led me to the wrong story island / the blueprint isn't where the wiki says. The world has **Story islands in a new order** or **Scrambled blueprints** on (9.4); `WorldOptions` shows which.

One of my islands never turns up. It may be unticked for this world (9.5): run `WorldIslands`, and `WorldIslands +<island>` lets it take part again. Its weight in `spawnpool.txt` may also be 0.

Load World is greyed out. Raft is offline from Steam. Check that Steam is online and restart Raft.

My island is far away / I can't find it. Build Raft's Receiver: custom islands are green dots with their distance.

I can't get onto a flying island (or a cliff island). Build stairs or pillars up from the raft. The generator's reach line tells a builder beforehand.

A friend can't see my island. Every player needs the mod, and the host's islands are the ones that count. Island files are sent to players who join; they appear as `<name>_<hash>.island` in their folder.

Where are my islands? In `<Raft>\Mods\DynamicIslands\` as `<name>.island`. Copy the file to share it.

The editor takes a moment to open. The first time after starting Raft it loads about 700 objects from Raft's islands; the loading box shows how far it is. After a Raft update it also scans Raft's other islands once, in the background (about half a minute; the object browser's status line says so).

Something went wrong. Press F10: the mod's messages start with `[CUSTOM ISLANDS]`. Raft's log is `%USERPROFILE%\AppData\LocalLow\Redbeet Interactive\Raft\Player.log`.

More: the [README](#) (every feature, file and command, and the known limitations).

This guide describes Custom Islands 3.0, the Experimental Alpha Release. It is kept up to date with the mod: every change to a feature updates this guide, the README and the PDF copy of this guide (`docs/Custom-Islands-Guide.pdf`) together.